

The smart Brailier

The Perkins SMART Brailier is built upon the newly released Next Generation Perkins Brailier, that helps the blind learn to type. <http://dgit.in/NmU63f>

zite

Zite at the end of the tunnel

Zite is one of the most popular news reading applications on iOS and Android. It is now finally available for WP7 devices. <http://dgit.in/NinLk3>

Sony DSC-RX100

Sony produces yet another game changer



With the DSC-RX100, Sony attempts the challenge of producing professional quality images from a compact, point and shoot camera.

The RX100 manages to house a 20.2 megapixel, 13.2x8.8mm CMOS sensor in a pocketable point and shoot body. As compared to regular point and shoot cameras that come with 1/2.3-inch sensors, the 1/1.6-inch sensor in the RX100 is a bit larger. Thus, allowing itself a slight advantage in terms of capturing more light to keep the noise under control at comparatively high ISO settings, along with richer color output and superior dynamic range. Apart from this sensor, the RX100 also comes with a superior quality lens, the Carl Zeiss Vario-Sonnar T*, 3.6x (28-100mm), with an aperture range of f/1.8-4.9. At 28mm, the wide open f/1.8 aperture lends a significant advantage in low-light conditions along with capturing images with soft, defocused background (bokeh), similar

to the results from good lenses on DSLR cameras.

Apart from the technical specs, the RX100 also scores high on design, the brushed aluminum body feels very solid and the overall construction of the camera is top notch. The control ring wrapped around the lens allows quick access to key settings depending on the mode that the unit is operating in. The back houses a large, 3-inch, high resolution (1,229k dots) LCD screen along with the usual four-button layout surrounding the control dial for quick access to settings. You also get a "movie" button placed on the top-right corner that allows instant video capture regardless of the mode the camera is set to. The RX100 supports 1080p video capture at 60fps along with dual recording, allowing you to capture video and shoot stills at the same time. The pop-up flash is housed at the extreme left corner along with a stereo microphone to its right, which ends up being almost at the center. The camera takes SD cards for storage and offers HDMI-out for direct connectivity with an HDTV. The battery charging happens inside the camera, via a micro USB connection, certainly not very convenient.

The camera is quick to power-up and very responsive and its focusing speed is blazing fast. Though, we did encounter occasional hiccups in a couple of low-light tests when the camera took longer than usual to achieve accurate focus. Its shutter response is excellent, almost in the same league as that of entry and mid-level DSLRs. The combination

of fast focusing and almost zero shutter lag allowed us to capture moving subjects and freeze action without any blur in the results, well done Sony!

With its larger CMOS sensor, the overall image quality of RX100 is clearly head and shoulders above the average point and shoot cameras. The sensor delivers punchy colors with very good contrast. The large sensor combined with the fast lens allows for images with very good depth and separation, similar to the output from micro 4/3rd and DSLR cameras. The RX100 scored very high in the ISO tests; noise is well controlled upto ISO 3200, allowing you to capture hand-held shots in challenging low-light conditions without lowering the shutter speed.

The Canon Powershot G1X is the only point and shoot camera that has a slight edge over the RX100 in terms of pure image quality. Given the G1X's size and weight, it hardly qualifies as a compact camera. The RX100 beats its immediate competitors, namely the Canon Powershot S100 and the Olympus XZ-1 by a huge margin. In a bid to stay pocketable, the RX 100 does lose out on some features. The absence of an optical view finder and the lack of any significant grip might be a deal-breaker for some purists who'd still prefer the retro styling and ergonomics of the Fujifilm X10.

However, as a package, the Sony RX 100 is the best and only option today for anyone looking for professional quality images from a truly compact point and shoot camera.

Swapnil Mathur

Specifications

Sensor: 20.2MP, CMOS;
Lens: Carl Zeiss Vario-Sonnar T*, 28-100mm (3.6x);
Aperture Range: f/1.8-4.9;
ISO Range: 80-6400; **Burst Mode:** 10fps; **Video Resolution:** 1920x1080, 60p

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Price: ₹34,990

8.0/10

Features 7.0
 Performance..... 9.0
 Build Quality 9.0
 Value for Money 7.0